

The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids

Ārya Arśa Praśamanī Sūtra · Toh 621 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་གཞན་འབཁུ་རབ་ཏུ་བྱ་བའི་བརྟེན་པའི་མཛན།

Toh 621 in the Kangyur is a sūtra known in English as The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids, corresponding to the Sanskrit Ārya Arśa Praśamanī Sūtra and the Tibetan Phakpa Zhangdrum Raptu Zhiwar Jepé Do. It belongs to the class of canonical Buddhist scriptures presented in the classic sūtra format, opening with the standard "Thus did I hear" prologue and set at Rājagṛha, where the Buddha addresses a great assembly of monks in the presence of his attendant Ānanda. The text is concerned with the relief and cure of hemorrhoids, representing a genre of practical or medicinal dhāraṇī-related sūtras in which the Buddha's teaching is directed toward alleviating a specific physical ailment through spiritual means. As part of the Kangyur, it sits among the collected word of the Buddha transmitted into Tibetan, preserving a tradition that understood the Buddha's compassionate activity as extending to the healing of bodily as well as spiritual suffering.

In the language of India: Ārya Arśa Praśamanī Sūtra. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove of Kalandaka, in the Cool Grove, together with a great Saṅgha of monks numbering around five hundred.

Then the Blessed One, on that very day of the full-moon restoration ceremony of the fifteenth, took his seat upon a prepared throne before the Saṅgha. At that time the venerable Ānanda stood to one side of the Blessed One holding a fan, fanning the Blessed One.

Then the venerable Ānanda arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his palms toward the Blessed One, bowed in the direction where the Blessed One was, and spoke these words to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, here in Rājagṛha there are many monks afflicted with hemorrhoids who are tormented by the pain of hemorrhoidal disease, experiencing unbearable, violent, unpleasant, and disagreeable feelings of

suffering. Venerable Blessed One, how shall I treat them?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared these words to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, learn this sūtra for clearing away hemorrhoids. Ānanda, whoever knows the name, the words, and the syllables of this sūtra for clearing away hemorrhoids — for as long as they live, they will not be struck by the disease of hemorrhoids, and for seven lifetimes they will be able to recall their past lives."

Tadyathā: Alante, amale, śvālicinī, kuśe, sambhave, svāhā.

"Ānanda, it is like this: in the northern direction, on the king of mountains called Himavat, there is a śāla tree called the Victorious One. It has three flowers. The first is called the Swelling One, the second is called the Soft One, the third is called the Dry One. Just as that one is dried, so may the wind-hemorrhoids of sentient beings be dried up. May the bile-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the phlegm-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the impure-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the blood-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the combined-hemorrhoids be dried up. Likewise, may the phlegm-hemorrhoids of myself and all sentient beings be dried up. May the impure-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the blood-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the combined-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the nasal-hemorrhoids be dried up. May the pendant-hemorrhoids be dried up.

Tadyathā: Śame śamāne, śame śamāne, svāhā.

May there be no inflammation. May there be no suppuration. May there be no discharge of sound. May there be no oozing. May there be no suffering. May there be no extreme suffering. May there be no outflow. May there be no excessive outflow. May they be exhausted right here, completely exhausted, and rendered nonexistent. May they go down into the earth.

Namo bhagavate, buddhāya, satyavātīnaṃ, siddhyantu mantrapadaḥ, svāhā."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda was delighted and rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said, and he praised it.

As for the ritual procedure, it is as follows: having accomplished the recitation, recite this seven times over a red thread, tie seven knots, and hang it around the neck.

The Noble Sūtra That Thoroughly Pacifies Hemorrhoids is complete.

Translated, revised, and definitively established by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

- The three "flowers" of the śāla tree named Victorious One are almost certainly therapeutic or botanical referents within an Indian medical framework correlating the three flowers (described as swelling, soft, and dry) with the drying action invoked for each type of hemorrhoid (wind, bile, phlegm, impure, blood, and combined). This is a folk-medical simile embedded in a ritual-dhāraṇī context rather than a straightforward botanical description.

The Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic renderings and are given here as they appear; the original Sanskrit forms may have been slightly altered in transmission.

The term rendered throughout as "hemorrhoids" (Tibetan: gzhang 'brum) denotes a range of anal and rectal growths or fistular conditions in traditional Tibetan medical literature, broadly corresponding to Sanskrit arśas, which covers hemorrhoids, fistulas, and related conditions. The title Sanskrit Arśa Praśamanī confirms this reading.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.